

The design of GaugeTheory/

Jinzheng Li

Draft for discussion, 22 September 2026; revised 24 September 2026

Text in blue was added after the first draft: sums of contents (Nathaneal, 23 September) and invariant reduction (24 September).

1 Purpose

Physlib/ClassicalFieldTheory/GaugeTheory/ is the symbolic framework for the local content of a gauge theory: the algebra in which a Lagrangian is written, the gauge and Lorentz actions on it, and the invariants of a given mass dimension. Fields enter only through their jets at one point, the formal symbols $\partial_s \psi_\alpha$.

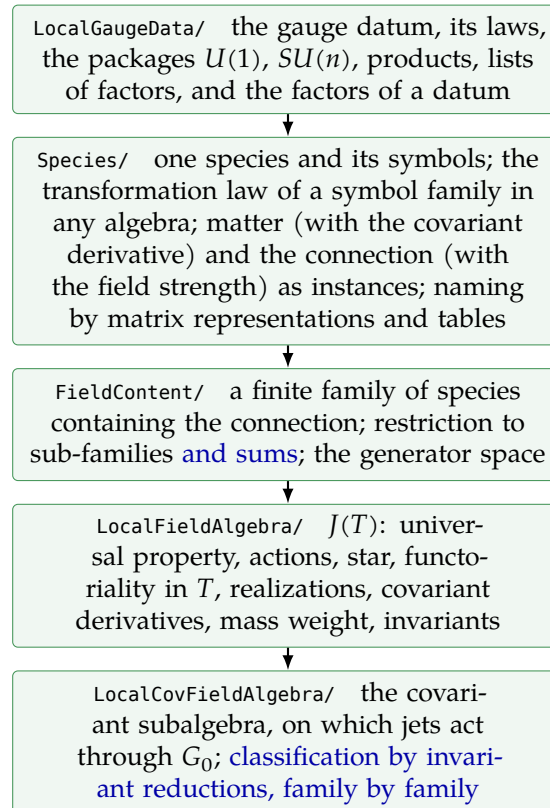
One rule organises the folder: **every layer takes a datum and returns constructions and theorems; a concrete theory contributes only its data**. The Standard Model is a list of gauge factors and a table of fields, and everything else about it is inherited. This note records the intended structure. The present tree differs from it (§6), and the open choices are in §5.

2 The idea

- **Gauge jets.** A gauge transformation is its jet U in a jet group G_J : value eval $U \in G_0$, Lie algebra $\mathfrak{g}_J$, derivatives, adjoint action, Maurer–Cartan form $\omega_\mu(U) = i(\partial_\mu U)U^{-1}$. These maps and their laws are the gauge datum; nothing downstream knows which group it is.
- **Species.** A species is a finite-dimensional V with a Lorentz representation, a parity, a mass weight, and an affine action of G_J on $\text{JetRing} \otimes V$, a linear part ℓ and a translation t with $t(UV) = t(U) + \ell(U)t(V)$. Matter has $t = 0$ and ℓ fibrewise, generated by an infinitesimal action of $\mathfrak{g}$. The connection has $\ell = \text{Ad}$, $t = \omega$.
- **The algebra.** A content T is a finite family of species containing the connection. $J(T)$ is the free graded-commutative algebra on the symbols of all species. Every action is defined on generators and extended by the universal property; the translation part gives the inhomogeneous term. Reality is a star structure. An inclusion of contents $S \subseteq T$ gives an injective equivariant map $J(S) \rightarrow J(T)$ with a retraction: sectors are its images, and the pure gauge theory is the connection-only content. **Contents also add: $F + G$ is the union of the two families glued along the connection, and $J(F + G)$ is the graded tensor product of $J(F)$ and $J(G)$ over the connection-only algebra, graded by which summands a word touches; both actions preserve the grading.**
- **Invariants.** Mass weight is twice the mass dimension (derivative 2, scalar 2, Weyl fermion 3, connection 2); the dimension-four Lagrangian is the gauge and Lorentz invariants of weight at most 8. On the covariant subalgebra jets act through G_0 , so classification is ordinary invariant theory, sector by sector. **It is done one family of terms at a time: a *reduction* `ReducesInvariantsTo` $\sigma \ V \ W$ says that for every σ -stable submodule S , an invariant of $V \sqcup S$**

lies in $W \sqcup S$. Reductions compose, combine over finite joins and transport along maps of index sets, and the family σ is any family of linear maps, so gauge and Lorentz invariance are one invariance for the disjoint union of the two groups. A classification of one family is a reduction of it to the span of its allowed contractions, proved in the quotient by the remainder. In particular, the invariants of an extension $F + G$ are those of F , those of G and those of the mixed part, and extending a classified theory (right-handed neutrinos, SMEFT operators, a new scalar) needs only the mixed invariants.

3 The layers



Imports go down the line only. Each layer exposes one structure as its datum, `LocalGaugeData`, `Species`, `FieldContent`, and proves everything for an arbitrary instance. Two points (now three) decide the shape:

- **One species notion.** Matter fields and the connection are both species, so the jet component space, the transformation law of a symbol family and the realization notion are stated once. The factors of a gauge datum belong to the gauge layer, not to matter.
- **One algebra tower.** The pure gauge theory is J of the connection-only content, and the sectors of $J(T)$ are images of sub-contents. Nothing is built twice and identified afterwards.
- **One classification mechanism.** The relation `ReducesInvariantsTo` Of `Mathematics/InvariantReduction` is general mathematics and stays there. The algebra layer supplies what every theory needs to use it: the gauge and Lorentz actions as one family indexed by $G_0 \sqcup SL(2, \mathbb{C})$, the reduction of a factor's invariance to that family, and the stability of symbol ranges. A classification theorem for one index law (a colour trace, an isospin contraction, a Lorentz scalar) is stated as a reduction modulo an arbitrary stable submodule, so it can be applied inside any larger expression and to any extension.

4 What a model sees

A model is a card and nothing else:

```
abbrev gauge : List FactorSpec := [.SU 3, .SU 2, .U1]
abbrev leptonDoublet : SpeciesData factors := (.L, .singlet, .fund, -3)
...
noncomputable def content : FieldContent gaugeData := table.toFieldContent
```

Species of the model are abbreviations of the value spaces the card produces, and theorems are stated in the card and the generic vocabulary alone, for example that the gauge and Lorentz invariants of content of weight at most 4 are spanned by 1 and H^+H .

5 Questions for discussion

1. **One species structure or two.** The affine law costs a translation field that is zero for all matter. Is the uniformity worth it, or should `MatterField` and the connection stay separate with the symbol-family law stated twice?
2. **Real or complex tower.** The connection's algebra is real today; the single tower is complex with a star. Does anything downstream need the real algebra as an object?
3. **The connection in the content.** Explicit member of the family (restriction becomes ordinary) or implicit through the gauge datum (as today)? [Explicit forces a sum \$F + G\$ to be glued along the connection; implicit allows a plain disjoint union.](#)
4. **Sectors by functoriality.** Restriction along $S \subseteq T$ fixes how species are indexed. Is that acceptable to the existing sector proofs? [Images of sub-contents give the "at most \$S\$ " subalgebras, but those proofs use the "exactly \$S\$ " pieces, and a sum has a mixed part in neither image. Should the grading by sub-families be part of this layer?](#)
5. **Names and order of work.** `Species`, `FieldContent`, `content` against the current names; and which of the steps below, if any, should precede the remaining Standard Model migration?

6 Distance from the current tree

current	intended
<code>LocalGaugeData/</code>	the same, plus the factor types now in <code>MatterField/MatrixRep/</code>
<code>MatterField/;</code> <code>GaugeBoson/Basic</code> , <code>GaugeBoson/Realization/</code>	<code>Species/</code>
<code>GaugeBoson/LocalGaugeFieldAlgebra/</code> , <code>GaugeBoson/LocalGaugeCovFieldAlgebra/</code>	the two algebra layers at the connection-only content
<code>GaugeFieldData/</code> <code>LocalFieldAlgebra/</code> , <code>LocalCovFieldAlgebra/</code>	<code>FieldContent/</code> , with the connection explicit
<code>Mathematics/InvariantReduction;</code> <code>StandardModel/InvariantReduction</code>	the same, sectors derived from functoriality the same; the combined family, the factor reductions and the range stabilities move into <code>LocalCovFieldAlgebra/</code>, stated for <code>ofFactors</code>

In the order they should be removed:

1. `LocalGaugeData/` imports `matter` (the factor types, and `TransformsIn`, `InfinitesimalAction` importing the covariant derivative). Move the factor types down and the two files into the species layer.

2. Matter and the connection have differently shaped APIs, `TransformsIn` for matter and `GaugeAlgebraRealization` for the connection. Introduce the species structure with both as instances.
3. Sectors are built by hand and the gauge sector identified with a separate algebra (four `GaugeSector` files). Prove functoriality and derive them.
4. The connection has its own real algebra tower of about 3300 lines. Replace it by the connection-only content, last, because the Standard Model gauge-sector classification is built on it.

Steps 1 and 2 are cleanup; 3 and 4 change shared conventions and need their owners.